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ADAR POONAWALLA, 42

CEO, SERUM INSTITUTE OF INDIA (SII)

A SHOT IN THE ARM

BECAUSE his commitment to help India fight the Covid virus has gone beyond simple business interests. Despite the low demand now, SII has decided to produce 5-6 million doses of Covishield; it has already produced the same amount of Covovax. This is to ensure that should there be a crisis, the country will be prepared

BECAUSE he is continuously investing in homegrown vaccines, which will not only improve accessibility but also bring down costs significantly. Last year, SII launched India's first homegrown HPV virus vaccine that helps protect against cervical cancer, the second most common cancer among Indian women. Currently, imported HPV vaccine costs around Rs 10,000, SII's version will be Rs 200-400 at government centres

BECAUSE The flamboyant Poonawalla is now also looking to encourage Indian entrepreneurs. The Poonawalla Vision Fund, with a corpus of Rs 1,000 crore, is keen to invest in growth stage start-ups

STARTING EARLY

Adar was just 20 and straight out of college when he started working in SII. He had no official designation at the time and spent the first few years simply shadowing his father at work

BECAUSE the Adar Poonawalla Clean City initiative has pledged Rs 100 crore for sanitation and waste collectiion services in Pune. It has 250 trucks trawling the city every day collecting and segregating 70 tonnes of waste